

# Ireland Data Centre Screening Matrix

## Quantitative Criteria and Regulatory Indicators for AI Agent Integration

### 1. Core Grid & Access Hard Data (Fatal Flaw Thresholds)

- **Grid Consumption Share (22%):** In 2024, data centres consumed 22% of Ireland's total metered electricity. This rapid growth has reached grid capacity limits.
- **PR6 Investment Period Constraint (to 2030):** System operators (EirGrid & ESB Networks) grid investment under the Price Review 6 (PR6) period (up to 2030) provides **no additional capacity allowance** for new data centre projects in the Greater Dublin Area unless they hold existing connection contracts. The probability of connection for new Dublin sites without an active contract is near **0%**.
- **Strategic Green Energy Parks Scale:** Regionally directed strategic hubs target large-scale co-located projects with a planning capacity in the **hundreds of megawatts (MW)**.

### 2. Green Energy & Co-location Quantitative Benchmarks

- **Corporate Power Purchase Agreements (CPPAs):** New site selections must strictly bind to renewable energy via CPPAs. Large-scale onshore/offshore wind and solar projects have transitioned fully away from Public Service Obligation (PSO) subsidies to private CPPA structures.
- **National Biomethane Target (5.7 TWh):** The Irish government has set a target of 5.7 Terawatt-hours (TWh) of biomethane by 2030. Under the CRU December 2025 Large Energy User connection policy, new data centres must provide **dispatchable backup generation**, with explicit policy preferences for utilizing indigenous biomethane.

### 3. EU Energy Efficiency & Digital Sovereignty Compliance

- **EU Tech Sovereignty Package:** Formally adopted on June 3, 2026, establishing strict data centre performance and governance mandates.
- **Mandatory Energy Efficiency Rating & Label:** Following the 2024 baselining, the EU is rolling out a Delegated Regulation that automatically generates an Electronic Sustainability Label and a mandatory rating classification based on actual data center operational metrics.
- **Minimum Performance Standards:** Phased mandatory phase-out of low-efficiency, high-energy-consuming legacy infrastructure.

### 4. Economic Impact & Investment Background Data

- **Tech Sector Output (20% GVA):** The digital infrastructure-supported tech ecosystem contributed approximately €95 billion in 2023, representing 20% of Ireland's total Gross Value Added.
- **Employment Contribution (7%):** As of Q4 2024, the sector directly employs 182,900 people (7% of Ireland's workforce), with 21,000 workers specifically dedicated to data centre operations and direct

ecosystem services.

- **Global Investment Benchmarks:** Global data centre investments doubled compared to 2022, reaching \$500 billion in 2024. Global data centre power consumption stood at 415 TWh in 2024 (1.5% of global power) and is projected to more than double by 2030.

5. Regulatory Roadmap & AI Agent Compliance Calendar

| Timeline    | Authority / Actor      | Regulatory Constraint / Objective                                                                           |
|-------------|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| From 2026   | EirGrid & ESB Networks | Enforce rigid PR6 capital budgets; no new grid expansion for uncontracted Dublin sites.                     |
| Within 2026 | DETE                   | Publish National Planning Statement mapping out legally protected Sustainable Energy Parks.                 |
| 2026 - 2027 | EU / Member States     | Full rollout of the June 2026 Energy Efficiency Labeling Act with rectification deadlines.                  |
| 2028+       | CRU & DECC             | Implement National Energy Demand Strategy (NEDS) with stackable network tariffs rewarding load flexibility. |